Page 1. The mitochondrion is the organelle in which most of the chemical energy of a cell is released. Glucose is first broken down in the cytoplasm, and the products then enter the mitochondrion, where a series of reactions transfers their energy to carrier molecules. Students often confuse respiration with breathing, but the two processes are different. Breathing moves air into and out of the lungs, while cellular respiration takes place inside every living cell of the body. The mitochondrion is the organelle in which most of the chemical energy of a cell is released. Glucose is first broken down in the cytoplasm, and the products then enter the mitochondrion, where a series of reactions transfers their energy to carrier molecules. Students often confuse respiration with breathing, but the two processes are different. Breathing moves air into and out of the lungs, while cellular respiration takes place inside every living cell of the body.

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